# Unit 11 — A Short Novel

Track G+M · Klasse 10 · Niveau G/M

# Learning objectives I

- *I can read three chapters of a short novel and identify protagonist arc, theme, and one stylistic move.*
- *I can write a 250-word literary essay with one quote.*
- *I can use whereas* and *while* (contrast) and *moreover / furthermore* (addition).

# Lead-in I

The class read three chapters of *The Slow Lane* by an imagined contemporary author — a short novel about a teenage long-distance runner. By chapter three, half the class had stopped seeing it as a sports book. Maja underlined the line *running, like reading, is a way of staying still while you move*. She showed the line to nobody for a week.

# Reading I

**Reading — *The Slow Lane*, ch. 3 extract**
*Running, like reading, is a way of staying still while you move. By the third week of training, I had discovered something I hadn't expected: the slow kilometres were the ones doing the work. Whereas the fast intervals felt like proof, the slow lanes felt like the actual training. Moreover, I learned that everyone faster than me said the same thing.*

**Grammar — contrast and addition connectives**
**Contrast:**

- *whereas* — formal: *Whereas the fast intervals felt like proof, the slow lanes felt like training.*

# Reading II

- *while* — slightly less formal.

**Addition:**

- *moreover* — formal addition of a stronger point.
- *furthermore* — formal extension.
- *in addition* — neutral.

Use sparingly — they cost weight. One per paragraph, not three.

# Practise I

**Niveau G**

1. Choose: *whereas / while / moreover / furthermore* — ___ the fast intervals felt like proof, the slow lanes felt like training.
2. Match: contrast → whereas/while; addition → moreover/furthermore. (T / F)

**Niveau M**

3. Build 4 sentences with one connective each.

# Your turn I

**Literary essay, 250 words.** Read the extract. Answer: *What is the protagonist's arc? What is the theme? Which stylistic move is doing the most work?* Use 1 *whereas* + 1 *moreover* + 1 direct quote.

**Sample**

*The narrator of The Slow Lane* arrives at chapter three having completed two weeks of training and expecting that the fast work was where the change would happen. Whereas the fast intervals felt like evidence — sweat, pain, observable progress — the slow lanes felt unfinished, almost lazy. The discovery, in the third week, is that the slow work was the work. The protagonist's small arc, in this extract, is the inversion of expectation: not what is loud, but what is quiet, becomes the centre. The theme is patience as a method, and the stylistic move doing

# Your turn II

the most work is the line *'running, like reading, is a way of staying still while you move.'* Without that line, the chapter is competent. With that line, the chapter quietly insists that physical training and mental work share the same shape. Moreover, the line works because the narrator has earned it — three weeks of slow kilometres are sitting behind it. The author, who is unnamed in our text, is making a small but real argument: that the things we underestimate (slow reading, slow running, slow anything) are usually where the actual change happens.

# Reflect I

- I can identify protagonist arc, theme, one stylistic move.
- I can use formal contrast and addition connectives.
- I can write a 250-word literary essay.

# Further reading / listening I

- Granta — accessible literary essays.
- London Review of Books — *Diary* short essays.